

SAM.gov Pre-Registration Checklist

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SAM.gov (System for Award Management) is the federal government's official vendor database. Before a contracting officer can award you a contract, your registration must be active, accurate, and complete. Most businesses register without this checklist — and spend weeks fixing errors. Do this first.

✓ THE 7-ITEM PRE-REGISTRATION CHECKLIST



ITEM 1

Legal Business Name (IRS-Exact Match)

Your business name in SAM.gov must match your IRS records exactly — including punctuation, LLC/Inc suffix, and spacing.

→ Pull your IRS EIN confirmation letter (CP 575) and use that name, character for character.



ITEM 2

EIN / Federal Tax ID Number

You need your Employer Identification Number (EIN) — also called a Federal Tax ID. This is NOT your Social Security Number.

→ 9-digit number in XX-XXXXXXX format. Get one free at IRS.gov in 10 minutes if you don't have one.



ITEM 3

Unique Entity Identifier (UEI)

SAM.gov replaced DUNS numbers with UEIs in April 2022. Your UEI is a 12-character alphanumeric code assigned when you register.

→ New registrant? SAM.gov assigns it during registration. Previously registered? Search your entity name at SAM.gov to find your assigned UEI.



ITEM 4

NAICS Codes (At Least One Primary)

6-digit codes that classify what your business does. Federal agencies use NAICS codes to find eligible contractors for each solicitation.

→ *Minimum 1 primary code. Recommended: 3–6 codes covering your full service range. Search at [census.gov/naics](https://www.census.gov/naics).*



ITEM 5

Bank Account for ACH Direct Deposit

Federal payments are made via Electronic Funds Transfer (EFT). You MUST provide business banking information during registration.

→ *Bank name, account type (checking), routing number, account number. Business account only — not personal.*



ITEM 6

Active Points of Contact

SAM.gov requires at least one email address. Contracting officers send award notifications and compliance notices here.

→ *Use a business email matching your domain (not Gmail/Yahoo). Monitor it daily.*



ITEM 7

12-Month Renewal Reminder

SAM.gov registrations expire every 12 months automatically. A lapsed registration — even by one day — makes you ineligible for contract awards.

→ *Set a calendar reminder 60 days before your renewal date before you complete registration.*

⚠ COMMON MISTAKES THAT DELAY REGISTRATION

- Using a personal email instead of a business email
- Business name doesn't match IRS records exactly
- Missing banking information (registration will be incomplete)
- Selecting NAICS codes that don't match actual services
- Forgetting to renew annually — registration silently expires

NEED HELP GETTING THIS RIGHT?

Free: Enroll in the H&C GovCon Starter Academy — free introduction to federal contracting. hcrelog.com/pricing-plans/list

SAM.gov Registration Support — \$197 one-time: We review your registration, confirm NAICS codes, and flag compliance gaps before you bid. Book

at **hcrelog.com**

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